



Staff Report

TO: Honorable Mayor and Members of the City Council
FROM: Kirk Pelser, Economic Development Director
BY: Laura James, Economic Development Manager
DATE: August 4, 2026
SUBJECT: 2026-2031 Economic Development Strategic Plan

Description: Presentation and consideration of the 2026-2031 Economic Development Strategic Plan.

Motion:

If the City Council determines that staff's recommendation is appropriate, the following motion is provided:

I move to adopt the 2026-2031 Economic Development Strategic Plan as presented.

Recommendation:

Staff recommends that the City Council adopt the 2026-2031 Economic Development Strategic Plan. Developed through comprehensive economic and demographic analysis, extensive stakeholder engagement, and community input, the plan provides a practical framework to guide Beaumont's economic development priorities, coordinate implementation, and build a more diversified and resilient local economy.

Discussion:

On July 2, 2019, the City Council approved Beaumont's first Economic Development Strategic Plan (EDSP). The plan established a framework to guide the City's economic development activities, including business attraction, business retention and expansion, entrepreneurial development, workforce development, placemaking, and other efforts to strengthen and diversify the local economy.

Since adoption of the 2019 EDSP, Beaumont has experienced substantial population growth, new commercial and industrial investment, changing market conditions, and evolving community priorities. The COVID-19 pandemic, demographic shifts, changes in consumer behavior, emerging development opportunities, and increased regional

competition also significantly altered the economic environment in which the City operates. An updated EDSP was therefore needed to ensure that the City's economic development priorities remain responsive, data-informed, and aligned with Beaumont's current and future needs.

On September 2, 2025, the City Council approved a Professional Services Agreement with TIP Strategies to prepare an update to the EDSP. TIP Strategies was selected through a competitive process that included review of seven proposals by an internal staff evaluation team and a supplemental evaluation team composed of three members of the Economic Development Committee. TIP was rated as the most qualified firm based on its experience with fast-growing communities, approach to inclusive community engagement, use of interactive data tools, and emphasis on implementation.

The planning process combined quantitative economic and demographic analysis with extensive stakeholder and community engagement. More than 75 participants contributed to the development of the plan through five roundtable discussions, 13 individual interviews, and three in-person and virtual community visioning workshops. Nearly 100 residents also participated in an online community visioning survey. Each member of the City Council was interviewed individually as part of the process.

The TIP Strategies consulting team traveled to Beaumont three times during the planning process to lead the in-person outreach outlined above: December 8-9, 2025, February 4-5, 2026, and March 3, 2026. The consultants will also attend the August 4, 2026 City Council meeting to present an overview of the plan and answer any questions.

To encourage broad participation, the City promoted public engagement opportunities through multiple channels, including direct email outreach to all homeowners' associations in Beaumont, the City's social media accounts, website and community calendar, flyers displayed at City Hall and the Beaumont Chamber of Commerce, inclusion in a Chamber email distribution, and direct, in-person outreach to community stakeholders.

A steering committee representing business, education, workforce development, real estate, government, nonprofit, and community interests also met at key milestones throughout the planning process. The proposed composition of the steering committee was reviewed and endorsed by the Economic Development Committee on November 12, 2025. Staff provided regular updates to the Economic Development Committee throughout the planning process.

In addition to community and stakeholder input, TIP Strategies conducted an economic analysis and an assessment of Beaumont's strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and

threats. The consultants also reviewed previously adopted City and regional plans to ensure that the updated EDSP builds upon and aligns with existing priorities, including the City's General Plan, Strategic Plan, Downtown Revitalization Plan, Zoning Code Update, Strategic Communications Plan, the 2019 EDSP, and Riverside County's Economic Development Strategic Plan.

The resulting 2026–2031 Economic Development Strategic Plan establishes the following vision:

Beaumont will leverage its rich history and sustained growth to build a thriving, self-sustaining economy, one that delivers quality local employment, excellent public services, and a connected quality of life centered around a revitalized historic downtown and a flourishing local business community.

The plan is grounded in four guiding principles – sustainability, equity, accountability, and livability – and is organized around six strategic initiatives:

1. **Business Retention and Expansion:** Proactively engage existing businesses, identify challenges, facilitate transitions, and remove barriers to continued success.
2. **Grow Target Industries:** Leveraging Beaumont's strategic position along the I-10 corridor, attract and scale high-growth sectors through infrastructure investment, specialized workforce development, and strategic business recruitment.
3. **Strengthen Retail Corridors:** Reinforce Beaumont's retail districts, revitalize downtown, support locally owned businesses, and capture a greater share of resident spending within the community.
4. **Activate Strategic Land and Sites:** Prepare and position key properties for development through infrastructure coordination, site readiness, streamlined processes, and a proactive annexation strategy.
5. **Enhance Quality of Place:** Support amenities, public spaces, connectivity, and experiences that strengthen Beaumont's appeal to residents, businesses, workers, and visitors.
6. **Promote and Position Beaumont:** Establish a consistent approach to communicating Beaumont's community identity, economic opportunities, competitive advantages, and business successes.

Together, these initiatives provide a framework for building a more diversified and resilient local economy, expanding access to quality local employment, strengthening the City's commercial and industrial tax base, supporting existing businesses, and enhancing Beaumont's overall quality of place.

Implementation and Supporting Deliverables

The EDSP is intended to function as an actionable road map rather than solely as a statement of long-term goals. Each of the six initiatives is supported by specific strategies and recommended actions informed by economic data, stakeholder input, community survey findings, and Beaumont's competitive position.

In addition to the EDSP and its action plan, TIP Strategies has prepared an Excel-based implementation matrix to support execution and ongoing progress monitoring. The matrix identifies recommended actions, priorities, suggested time frames, required resources, potential supporting partners, implementation status, and accomplishments. Its flexible format will allow staff to update timelines, measures, and approaches as economic conditions and City priorities evolve.

The consultant's scope also includes the delivery of a digital toolkit to assist the City in communicating the plan's vision, principles, initiatives, and progress to the public and other stakeholders. The toolkit will support clear and consistent messaging as implementation moves forward.

Implementation will occur over the plan's five-year horizon and will require coordination among multiple City departments as well as collaboration with public, private, educational, workforce, and community partners. Individual actions requiring future funding, policy direction, contracts, or other City Council authorization will be brought forward separately as appropriate. Staff will also use the implementation matrix to monitor progress and report accomplishments.

Approval and adoption of the 2026-2031 Economic Development Strategic Plan will provide the City with a coordinated, data-informed framework for supporting existing businesses, attracting targeted investment, expanding local employment opportunities, strengthening retail and commercial corridors, revitalizing downtown, and diversifying the City's tax base. A stronger and more resilient local economy generates resources to support essential public services and community investment while improving access to jobs, goods, services, amenities, and opportunities for Beaumont residents.

The plan also advances transparency and accountability by establishing defined priorities, recommended actions, implementation time frames, and a structure for monitoring and communicating progress.

Fiscal Impact:

The Professional Services Agreement with TIP Strategies in an amount not to exceed \$110,000 was approved by City Council on September 2, 2025. Approval and adoption

of the completed plan will not result in an additional fiscal impact. Implementation costs will vary by strategy and action. Many recommendations can be advanced through interdepartmental coordination, adopted programs, partnerships, and currently budgeted resources. Any implementation actions requiring additional funding commitments from the City will be presented to City Council as appropriate for consideration.

Alternatives:

The City Council may:

1. Adopt the 2026-2031 Economic Development Strategic Plan as presented;
2. Decline to adopt the plan and provide direction to staff.

Attachments:

- A. 2026-2031 Economic Development Strategic Plan
- B. Economic Development Strategic Plan Implementation Matrix

2026–2031

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT STRATEGIC PLAN

